

Night Waking Response Planner

Pre-write your plan. Your tired brain just has to follow it.

7 waking types · Response scripts · 7-night log

Self-settling tracker · Weekly review · Pattern finder

How to Use

My Plan Overview

Night 1 Log

Weekly Review

"The plan you write at 2 p.m. is the one your 2 a.m. brain will thank you for."

— Sleep, Baby. Please. · Chapter 7

CONTENTS

Planner Contents

Tap any item to jump directly to that page.

How to Use This Planner

My Plan — Setup

Waking Type 1: Hunger / Nutritional Waki

Waking Type 2: Habit / Association Wakin

Waking Type 3: Comfort / Connection Waki

Waking Type 4: Developmental / Leap Waki

Waking Type 5: Environmental Waking

Waking Type 6: Overtired / Undertired Wa

Waking Type 7: Pain / Illness / Discomfo

Night 1 Log

Night 2 Log

Night 3 Log

Night 4 Log

Night 5 Log

Night 6 Log

Night 7 Log

Weekly Review — Pattern Finder

Revised Plan — Week 2

Quick Reference Card

■ Previous

■ Home

Next ■

How to Use This Planner

A plan written before the night beats decisions made in the dark.

1 Read Chapter 7 first

This planner is the hands-on companion. The chapter explains the why; this planner captures your what.

2 Identify your baby's waking types

Pages 3–9 walk through each type. Read the cues. Check off what applies.

3 Write your response plan — in daylight

For each waking type, write exactly what you will do. Specific, step-by-step.

4 Log every night for 7 nights

Pages 10–16 give you a full log for each night. Patterns only appear with data.

5 Review on Day 7

The weekly review (page 17) separates genuine needs from habit wakings.

The two rules this planner is built on:

- ① Pause 2–3 minutes before going in. Many wakings self-resolve.
- ② Decide your response before the waking happens — not during it.

[■ Previous](#)[■ Home](#)[Next ■](#)

My Night Response Plan — Setup

Fill this before the first night. Post it where you can see it.

Baby's Details

Baby's Name

Age Right Now

Planner Start Date

Current Sleep Challenge (one line)

Biggest Habit to Break

My Wait-Before-I-Go Policy

How long will I pause before entering the room when I hear a sound?

☐

0–1 min

☐

2–3 min

☐

3–5 min

☐

5+ min

Respond quickly — we're early in training. Standard pause — give self-settling a chance. Extended pause — well-established sleep. Following graduated method strictly.

My Chosen Sleep Method (from Chapter 6)

☐

Extinction (CIO)

☐

Ferber (Graduated)

☐

Chair Method

☐

Fading

☐

Pick Up / Put Down

Method note:

Sleep Debt Traps I Am Actively Avoiding

Check what you're committing to avoid (after the first few months):

☐

Feeding to sleep at bedtime

☐

Rocking fully to sleep at bedtime

☐

Bringing baby to our bed as a night rescue

☐

Rushing in before the wait window

☐

Switching methods mid-week

☐

Using motion sleep (swing/pram) for all naps

Partner / Co-Parent Sync

Who handles odd nights?

Who handles even nights?

One agreed rule we both follow if the other deviates:

Hunger / Nutritional Waking

Baby genuinely needs a feed. Usually before 6–9 months.

How to Recognise This Waking

Check all cues that apply to your baby right now:

- ☐ Rhythmic, escalating cry — not easily soothed
- ☐ Rooting reflex / mouthing movements
- ☐ Short time since last feed relative to age
- ☐ Under 6 months or post-growth-spurt

Does this type apply to my baby currently?



Yes — I need a plan for this



Not yet

My response plan for hunger wakings:

Write your step-by-step response. Be specific. Your tired brain will follow this exactly.

Step 1 — First action (in room or out?):

Step 2 — If not settled after wait window:

Step 3 — If still not settled after 10 min:

Hint: e.g. Feed fully in dim room. No stimulation. Back down drowsy-awake.

When This Waking Gets Flagged for Review

I will escalate / reassess if this waking type occurs more than:



2×/night



3×/night



4+×/night

If this waking type persists unchanged for more than 7 days, I will:

201cYou wrote the plan in daylight so your exhausted brain doesn't have to decide at 2 a.m.201d

Habit / Association Waking

Baby wakes expecting the same conditions they fell asleep with.

How to Recognise This Waking

Check all cues that apply to your baby right now:

- ☐ Waking at predictable, regular intervals (often ~45 min or 90 min)
- ☐ Calms immediately when the association is offered
- ☐ Old enough that hunger is unlikely (6+ months)
- ☐ Fed or rocked to sleep at bedtime

Does this type apply to my baby currently?

☐

Yes — I need a plan for this

☐

Not yet

My response plan for habit/association wakings:

Write your step-by-step response. Be specific. Your tired brain will follow this exactly.

Step 1 — First action (in room or out?):

Step 2 — If not settled after wait window:

Step 3 — If still not settled after 10 min:

Hint: e.g. Wait 3 min. Do not feed. Use chosen method to resettle.

When This Waking Gets Flagged for Review

I will escalate / reassess if this waking type occurs more than:

☐

2×/night

☐

3×/night

☐

4+×/night

If this waking type persists unchanged for more than 7 days, I will:

201cA consistent response — even an imperfect one — is infinitely better than a different one every night.201d

Comfort / Connection Waking

Baby wants closeness, not food or a specific habit.

How to Recognise This Waking

Check all cues that apply to your baby right now:

- ☐ Quiets with touch or voice — not specific feed/rock
- ☐ More common during developmental leaps or illness
- ☐ May have been a well-settled sleeper before this
- ☐ Calms with brief reassurance then re-settles

Does this type apply to my baby currently?

☐

Yes — I need a plan for this

☐

Not yet

My response plan for comfort wakings:

Write your step-by-step response. Be specific. Your tired brain will follow this exactly.

Step 1 — First action (in room or out?):

Step 2 — If not settled after wait window:

Step 3 — If still not settled after 10 min:

Hint: e.g. Pat/shush in crib. 2 min voice only. Exit once calm.

When This Waking Gets Flagged for Review

I will escalate / reassess if this waking type occurs more than:

☐

2×/night

☐

3×/night

☐

4+×/night

If this waking type persists unchanged for more than 7 days, I will:

201cPause before you go. Many wakings resolve in 2–3 minutes on their own.201d

■ Previous

■ Home

Next ■

Developmental / Leap Waking

Temporary regression tied to a growth or brain leap.

How to Recognise This Waking

Check all cues that apply to your baby right now:

- ☐ Sudden return of waking after a settled period
- ☐ Increased fussiness or clinginess during the day
- ☐ Near a known leap window (4 mo, 6 mo, 8–10 mo, 12 mo...)
- ☐ Lasts 1–3 weeks then resolves

Does this type apply to my baby currently?

☒

Yes — I need a plan for this

☐

Not yet

My response plan for developmental wakings:

Write your step-by-step response. Be specific. Your tired brain will follow this exactly.

Step 1 — First action (in room or out?):

Step 2 — If not settled after wait window:

Step 3 — If still not settled after 10 min:

Hint: e.g. Offer extra comfort. Maintain routine. Ride it out 1–2 weeks.

When This Waking Gets Flagged for Review

I will escalate / reassess if this waking type occurs more than:

☐

2×/night

☐

3×/night

☐

4+×/night

If this waking type persists unchanged for more than 7 days, I will:

201cYou are not failing your baby. You are teaching them the most important sleep skill of their life.201d

■ Previous

■ Home

Next ■

Environmental Waking

External factor woke or kept the baby awake.

How to Recognise This Waking

Check all cues that apply to your baby right now:

- ☐ Woke at an unusual time / not their pattern
- ☐ Room too hot, too cold, or too light
- ☐ External noise — traffic, sibling, alarm
- ☐ White noise failed or isn't loud enough

Does this type apply to my baby currently?

☒

Yes — I need a plan for this

☐

Not yet

My response plan for environmental wakings:

Write your step-by-step response. Be specific. Your tired brain will follow this exactly.

Step 1 — First action (in room or out?):

Step 2 — If not settled after wait window:

Step 3 — If still not settled after 10 min:

Hint: e.g. Check room temp, white noise. Resettle with minimal interaction.

When This Waking Gets Flagged for Review

I will escalate / reassess if this waking type occurs more than:

☐

2×/night

☐

3×/night

☐

4+×/night

If this waking type persists unchanged for more than 7 days, I will:

201cProgress is not a straight line. One hard night does not erase five good ones.201d

■ Previous

■ Home

Next ■

Overtired / Undertired Waking

Sleep timing is off — too much or too little sleep pressure.

How to Recognise This Waking

Check all cues that apply to your baby right now:

- ☐ Overtired: hard to settle, wakes shortly after going down
- ☐ Undertired: wakes after a full cycle and can't go back
- ☐ Awake windows not matching baby's current developmental stage
- ☐ Nap timing or length is off

Does this type apply to my baby currently?

☒

Yes — I need a plan for this

☐

Not yet

My response plan for timing-related wakings:

Write your step-by-step response. Be specific. Your tired brain will follow this exactly.

Step 1 — First action (in room or out?):

Step 2 — If not settled after wait window:

Step 3 — If still not settled after 10 min:

Hint: e.g. Review awake windows. Adjust bedtime by 15 min tomorrow.

When This Waking Gets Flagged for Review

I will escalate / reassess if this waking type occurs more than:

☐

2×/night

☐

3×/night

☐

4+×/night

If this waking type persists unchanged for more than 7 days, I will:

201cThe goal isn't a perfect night. It's a more predictable, more confident response to whatever comes.201d

■ Previous

■ Home

Next ■

Pain / Illness / Discomfort

Physical cause that needs to be ruled out first.

How to Recognise This Waking

Check all cues that apply to your baby right now:

- ☐ Inconsolable cry — nothing helps
- ☐ Signs of illness (fever, congestion, rash)
- ☐ Teething symptoms (drool, gum rubbing)
- ☐ Unusual body language — pulling ears, arching

Does this type apply to my baby currently?

☐

Yes — I need a plan for this

☐

Not yet

My response plan for pain/illness wakings:

Write your step-by-step response. Be specific. Your tired brain will follow this exactly.

Step 1 — First action (in room or out?):

Step 2 — If not settled after wait window:

Step 3 — If still not settled after 10 min:

Hint: e.g. Comfort fully. Address medical needs. Resume routine once recovered.

When This Waking Gets Flagged for Review

I will escalate / reassess if this waking type occurs more than:

☐

2×/night

☐

3×/night

☐

4+×/night

If this waking type persists unchanged for more than 7 days, I will:

201cSleep is coming. For both of you.201d

■ Previous

■ Home

Next ■

Night 1 — Waking Log

Record every waking. Honest data reveals the pattern.

Night Setup

Date

Bedtime

Time Asleep

Morning Wake

Waking Log

Time	Type	My Response	Self-Settled?	Back Down	Duration
#1			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#2			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#3			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#4			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#5			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#6			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		

Did I follow my written response plan tonight?

☐ Fully

☐ Mostly

☐ Deviated

Night Notes

Anything that affected this night (illness, travel, deviation from plan):

[■ Previous](#)
[■ Home](#)
[Next ■](#)

Night 2 — Waking Log

Record every waking. Honest data reveals the pattern.

Night Setup

Date

Bedtime

Time Asleep

Morning Wake

Waking Log

Time	Type	My Response	Self-Settled?	Back Down	Duration
#1			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#2			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#3			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#4			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#5			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#6			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		

Did I follow my written response plan tonight?

☐ Fully

☐ Mostly

☐ Deviated

Night Notes

Anything that affected this night (illness, travel, deviation from plan):

[■ Previous](#)
[■ Home](#)
[Next ■](#)

Night 3 — Waking Log

Record every waking. Honest data reveals the pattern.

Night Setup

Date

Bedtime

Time Asleep

Morning Wake

Waking Log

Time	Type	My Response	Self-Settled?	Back Down	Duration
#1			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#2			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#3			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#4			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#5			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#6			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		

Did I follow my written response plan tonight?

☐ Fully

☐ Mostly

☐ Deviated

Night Notes

Anything that affected this night (illness, travel, deviation from plan):

[■ Previous](#)
[■ Home](#)
[Next ■](#)

Night 4 — Waking Log

Record every waking. Honest data reveals the pattern.

Night Setup

Date

Bedtime

Time Asleep

Morning Wake

Waking Log

Time	Type	My Response	Self-Settled?	Back Down	Duration
#1			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#2			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#3			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#4			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#5			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#6			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		

Did I follow my written response plan tonight?

☐ Fully

☐ Mostly

☐ Deviated

Night Notes

Anything that affected this night (illness, travel, deviation from plan):

[■ Previous](#)
[■ Home](#)
[Next ■](#)

Night 5 — Waking Log

Record every waking. Honest data reveals the pattern.

Night Setup

Date

Bedtime

Time Asleep

Morning Wake

Waking Log

Time	Type	My Response	Self-Settled?	Back Down	Duration
#1			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#2			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#3			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#4			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#5			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#6			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		

Did I follow my written response plan tonight?

☐ Fully

☐ Mostly

☐ Deviated

Night Notes

Anything that affected this night (illness, travel, deviation from plan):

[■ Previous](#)
[■ Home](#)
[Next ■](#)

Night 6 — Waking Log

Record every waking. Honest data reveals the pattern.

Night Setup

Date

Bedtime

Time Asleep

Morning Wake

Waking Log

Time	Type	My Response	Self-Settled?	Back Down	Duration
#1			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#2			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#3			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#4			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#5			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#6			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		

Did I follow my written response plan tonight?

☐ Fully

☐ Mostly

☐ Deviated

Night Notes

Anything that affected this night (illness, travel, deviation from plan):

[■ Previous](#)
[■ Home](#)
[Next ■](#)

Night 7 — Waking Log

Record every waking. Honest data reveals the pattern.

Night Setup

Date

Bedtime

Time Asleep

Morning Wake

Waking Log

Time	Type	My Response	Self-Settled?	Back Down	Duration
#1			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#2			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#3			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#4			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#5			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		
#6			☐ Y ☐ N ☐ P		

Did I follow my written response plan tonight?

☐ Fully

☐ Mostly

☐ Deviated

Night Notes

Anything that affected this night (illness, travel, deviation from plan):

[■ Previous](#)
[■ Home](#)
[Next ■](#)

7-Night Review — Pattern Finder

Look at the data. Separate genuine needs from habit. Adjust one lever.

7-Night Sleep Stats

Best night (fewest wakings)

Hardest night (most wakings)

Avg wakings / night

Most common waking type

Longest uninterrupted stretch

Self-Settling Tracker

For each night, mark how many wakings self-resolved (S) vs needed intervention (I):

N1

S:

I:

N2

S:

I:

N3

S:

I:

N4

S:

I:

N5

S:

I:

N6

S:

I:

N7

S:

I:

Total self-settled across week:

Total interventions:

Review Questions

Q1 Which wakings self-settled without my help?

Note the type and time — this reveals what they can already do.

Q2 Which wakings genuinely needed intervention?

Hunger and pain always do. Habit/comfort often don't.

Q3 Did I respond consistently with my written plan?

Yes/No. If No — what changed, and why?

Q4 What pattern am I seeing across multiple nights?

Same time every night? Same type? This shapes tomorrow's plan.

Q5 One thing to adjust in my plan based on this week:

Small, specific change only. One lever at a time.

■ Previous

■ Home

Next ■

Revised Response Plan — Week 2

One plan, adjusted by evidence. Small changes. Committed execution.

What I'm Changing (and Why)

Change to wait window (if any)

Only change things the data showed. One lever at a time.

Change to method (if any)

Waking type with biggest improvement last week

Waking type still needing the most work

Revised Response Plan by Waking Type

Update any type where last week's plan wasn't working. Leave blank if plan is unchanged.

Hunger / Nutritional

Habit / Association

Comfort / Connection

Developmental / Leap

Environmental

Timing / Over-Undertired

Pain / Illness

☐

I have updated this plan based on what I observed. I commit to 5 more consistent nights.

Week 2 Start Date

■ Previous

■ Home

Next ■

Quick Reference — Print & Post

One page. Everything you need at 2 a.m.

Rule #1 — Wait Before You Go

Hear a sound → pause 2–3 min → listen → is it escalating? → then decide.

Waking Type → My Response (Summary)

■ Hunger	Under 6 mo: likely yes. Over 9 mo: likely habit.	
■ Habit	Don't offer the association. Use your method.	
■ Comfort	Brief reassurance. Don't linger. Exit calmly.	
■ Developmental	Temporary. Extra comfort OK. Hold the routine.	
■ Environmental	Check room. Fix the cause. Resettle.	
■ Timing	Note the time. Adjust tomorrow. Don't feed.	
■ Pain/Illness	Comfort fully. Medical need first. Resume after.	

Night Feeding — Is It Hunger or Habit?

Age	Expected Feeds	Guidance
0–3 months	2–4 feeds expected	Do not reduce — nutritional
3–4 months	1–3 feeds	Focus on drowsy-awake first
4–6 months	1–2 feeds	Begin gradual reduction if weight good
6–9 months	0–1 feed	Most can handle 0 with pediatric OK
9+ months	0 in most cases	Likely habit — follow your method

"Consistency on hard nights is where progress is made. You're in it. Keep going."

— Sleep, Baby, Please. · Chapter 7

■ Previous

■ Home

Next ■